

Public transit

As industrial cities, such as London and Paris, grew bigger in the early 19th century, a growing number of people lived farther away from their places of work. This spurred the growth of public transportation systems. Some commuters caught trains to work, and more and more people had to use horse-drawn buses and later motor buses and streetcars.

Arm in contact with overhead cable



First electric streetcar

- **What?** Siemens streetcar
- **Who?** Werner von Siemens
- **Where and when?** Germany, 1881

The world's first electric streetcar system opened in St. Petersburg, Russia, but Berlin was the first city to develop it properly

with the Siemens streetcar of 1881. Berlin had already run horse-drawn streetcars for 20 years, so the switch to electric was simple. These electric streetcars ran on tracks and were powered by electricity from overhead cables.

The motor bus

- **What?** B-type bus
- **Who?** Frank Searle
- **Where and when?** UK, 1909

London led the way with motor buses, especially its famous red-painted, open-topped double deckers. The legendary B-type was the world's first mass-produced bus. About 900 of these buses were also adapted for carrying troops during World War I.



First charter bus

- **What?** Mercedes-Benz O 10000
- **Who?** Mercedes-Benz
- **Where and when?** Germany, 1938

Until the 1930s, buses were mostly used for short city rides, but with the creation of autobahns (see p.103) in Germany, German bus makers began to build large, fast buses for long journeys. The powerful, long-nosed Mercedes-Benz O 10000 was the biggest of these.

